

Five Colored Lights

五老之光 Wǔ Lǎo Zhī Guāng — Five-Element Organ Light Breathing

ORIGINS

This practice draws on one of the deeper currents of Daoist cosmology: the Five Pure Ones (Wǔ Lǎo, the "Five Ancient Lords"), five primordial lights understood to give birth to everything that follows from them — the five elements, the five organs, the five senses, the five emotions and their corresponding virtues, both within the body and beyond it. Working directly with these five colours is a simple practice on its surface, and an extremely old and deep one underneath it.

WHAT IT IS FOR

Each organ is cleared of what it is holding and then filled with its own primordial light. We breathe in colour from the furthest edges of the universe; we breathe out what no longer serves, seen as dirty grey-black smoke. Once an organ has released enough, the exhale changes function — it now fills the organ with light rather than emptying it. The organ begins to glow. We smile inwardly into it, and feel it smiling back.

FOUR WAYS TO BREATHE

In, and out, each in the same four ways

1 Simple Breath

The most direct method — simply breathe the colour in on the inhale, and the grey-black smoke out on the exhale, without directing it through any particular gate.

2 Pore-Breathing

The whole body draws the light in through every pore of the skin at once, and releases the smoke the same way — a whole-body inhale and exhale, not localised to the nose or mouth.

3 Direct Through the Organ

Breath is drawn in and released directly through the region of the body where the organ itself sits — the light entering and the smoke leaving through that area alone.

4 Through the Sense Gate

Each organ has an associated sense organ, and breath may be drawn in and released through that gate specifically — the tip of the tongue for the Heart, the mouth for the Spleen, and so on for each organ below.



1 · HEART

Fire · Red / Pink · Sense Gate: Tip of the Tongue



1 Heart · Small Intestine

Releases Hatred, Impatience

Execute

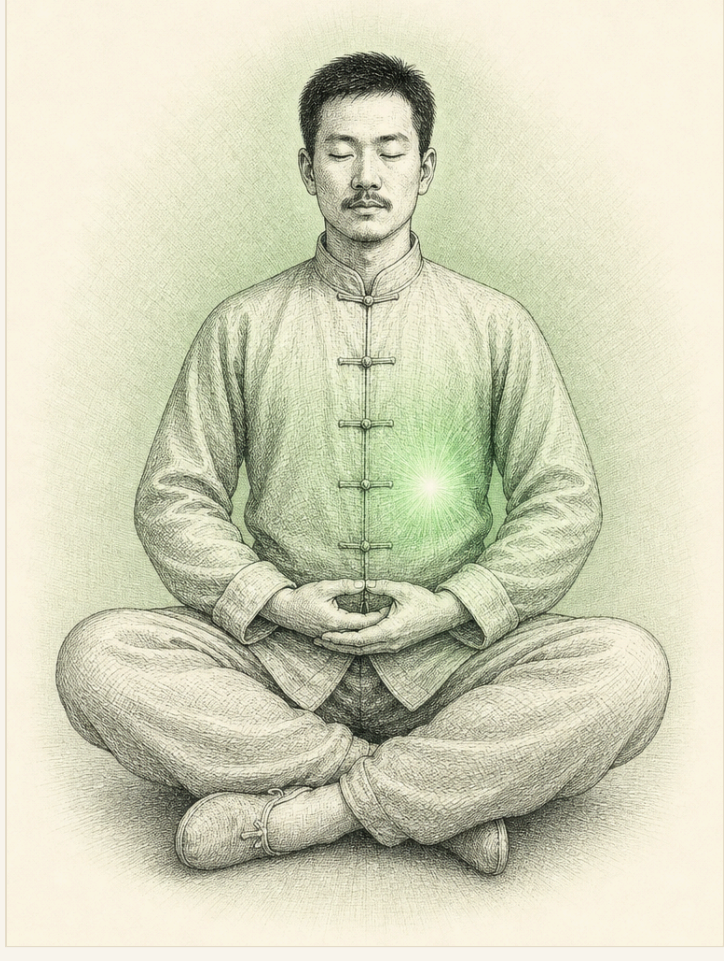
Draw red or pink light in from the furthest edges of the universe, using any of the four methods above — through the tip of the tongue is the classical gate for the Heart. Breathe the colour in; breathe out any hatred, impatience, or self-pity as dirty grey-black smoke. After several rounds of release, let the exhale change function: breathe the light in, and let the exhale now fill the Heart with red or pink radiance instead of emptying it.

Virtue Revealed

As the Heart clears and begins to glow, smile inwardly into it. Feel it smiling back. What shines forth here, once cleared, is love, joy, and honour.

2 · LIVER

Wood · Emerald Green · Sense Gate: The Eyes



2 Liver · Gall Bladder

Releases Anger

Execute

Draw emerald green light in, through the eyes or through whichever of the four methods you are using. Breathe the colour in; breathe out anger as dirty grey-black smoke. After several rounds, let the exhale turn to filling — breathe the green light in, and let the exhale fill the Liver with emerald radiance.

Virtue Revealed

Smile inwardly into the Liver as it begins to glow, and feel it smile back. What shines forth here, once cleared, is kindness.

3 · SPLEEN

Earth · Golden Yellow · Sense Gate: The Mouth



3 Spleen · Stomach

Releases Worry

Execute

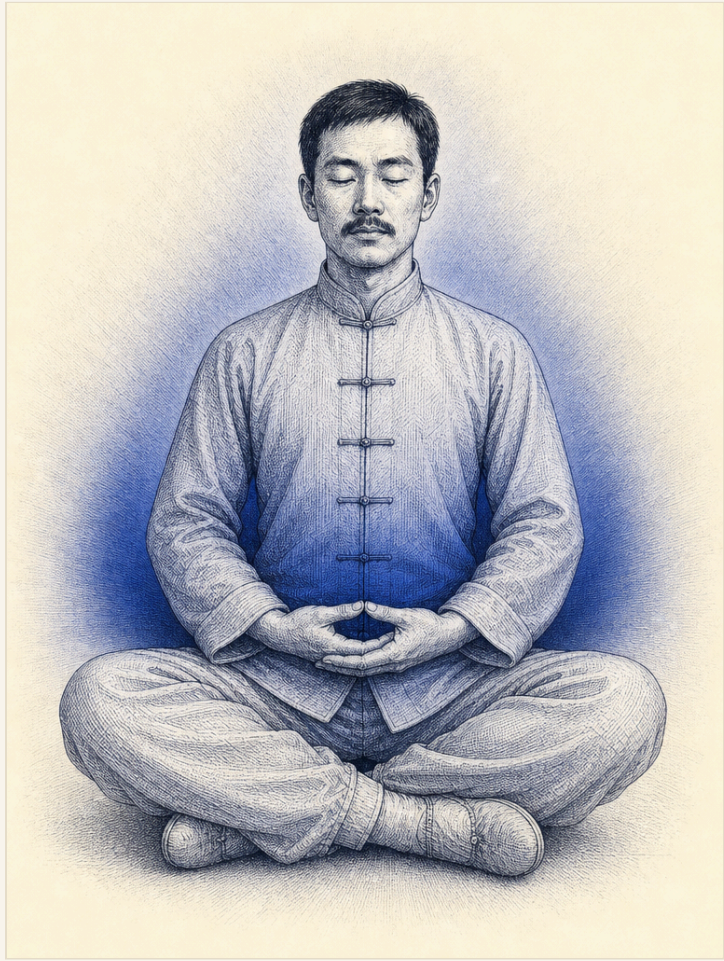
Draw golden yellow light in, through the mouth or through whichever of the four methods you are using. Breathe the colour in; breathe out worry as dirty grey-black smoke. After several rounds, let the exhale turn to filling — breathe the gold light in, and let the exhale fill the Spleen with golden radiance.

Virtue Revealed

Smile inwardly into the Spleen as it begins to glow, and feel it smile back. What shines forth here, once cleared, is fairness and openness.

4 · KIDNEYS

Water · Blue / Black · Sense Gate: The Ears



4 Kidney · Bladder

Releases Fear

Execute

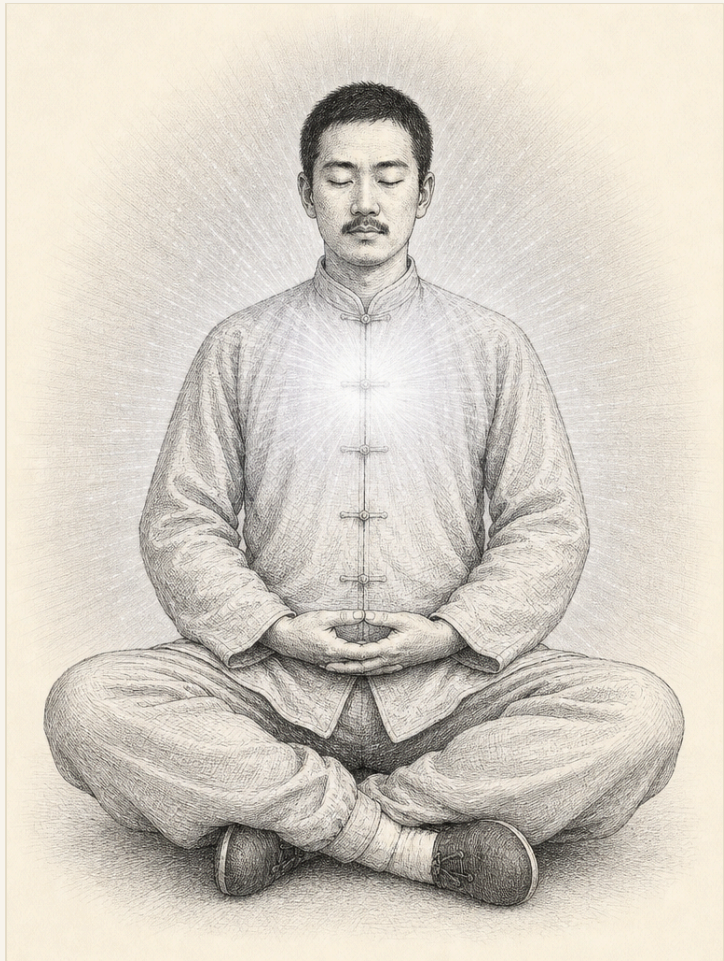
Draw deep blue or black light in, through the ears or through whichever of the four methods you are using. Breathe the colour in; breathe out fear as dirty grey-black smoke. After several rounds, let the exhale turn to filling — breathe the light in, and let the exhale fill the Kidneys with deep blue-black radiance.

Virtue Revealed

Smile inwardly into the Kidneys as they begin to glow, and feel them smile back. What shines forth here, once cleared, is gentleness.

5 · LUNGS

Metal · White or Silver · Sense Gate: The Nose



5 Lung · Large Intestine

Releases Grief

Execute

Draw white or silver light in, through the nose or through whichever of the four methods you are using. Breathe the colour in; breathe out grief and sadness as dirty grey-black smoke. After several rounds, let the exhale turn to filling — breathe the light in, and let the exhale fill the Lungs with white or silver radiance.

Virtue Revealed

Smile inwardly into the Lungs as they begin to glow, and feel them smile back. What shines forth here, once cleared, is courage and integrity.

INNER VISION

The Five Colored Lights, Seen Together

At the end of the full sequence, turn attention inward and simply look. See — or feel — all five organs at once, each glowing steadily with its own light: the Heart's red or pink, the Liver's emerald green, the Spleen's gold, the Kidneys' deep blue-black, the Lungs' white or silver. Five lights, held together in a single field of inner vision, each one distinct and each one part of the same primordial radiance.

PRACTICE NOTES & THE TWO PHASES OF BREATH

PRACTICE NOTES

- Can be practised entirely on its own, or paired with any of the other qigong forms taught here — it sits comfortably before, after, or woven between other practices.
- Each organ may be worked individually, with as much time and repetition as is needed, whether the focus is a specific emotion, a specific physical concern, or simply general clearing.
- Where one organ clearly needs more attention — through an emotional pattern, an energetic state, or a physical symptom — give it more time and more rounds, while still completing the full five-organ series rather than stopping there.

THE TWO PHASES OF BREATH

- Every organ is worked in two phases, in this order: first, several rounds of releasing — breathing the colour in, and breathing the grey-black smoke of toxicity out — until the release feels complete.
- Only then does the exhale change function, so that both the inhale and the exhale are now filling the organ with its own light, until it visibly and palpably glows.